

TSSP Reference Manual

Time Segmented Sub Project — Dr. UV's Chunking Method

A reference for re-reading when motivation slips and overwhelm returns

Coined by	Dr. UV (052026-wed-640pm-UV-CL)
Purpose	Break overwhelming tasks into time-bounded chunks with deliverables
Reference use	Re-read when motivation slips, overwhelm returns, or session pacing wavers
Project	Dr. UVC Market Insights (filed here; cross-applicable to all UV projects)
Companion docs	All session SUMMARY/TRANSCRIPT PDFs serve as TSSP execution examples

The core principle — in one sentence

A TSSP is a time-bounded chunk of work, scoped to a single defined output, with a planned start and a planned wrap, designed to be small enough that you can begin even when motivation is low.

The overwhelming feeling that strikes when looking at a large project is not a sign of lack of capability — it is a sign that the project, as currently framed, exceeds working memory. The remedy is not more willpower. It is smaller chunks. TSSP is the explicit naming of the chunking discipline you already operate, made repeatable so it works even on days when intuition would not produce it naturally.

UV's framing — verbatim

"I have several projects running in parallel as you know....sometimes some tasks are overwhelming..I want to break down to small chunks..I call this..Time Segmented Sub project..TSSP"

Three things in this framing are worth preserving:

- **'Several projects running in parallel.'** The reality TSSP serves is multi-project execution — not single-project deep focus. The method must work when context-switching is unavoidable.
- **'Sometimes overwhelming.'** Not always. TSSP is not the answer for every task — it is the answer for tasks where overwhelm interferes with starting. Some work is best done in long blocks. Use the right tool for the moment.
- **'Break down to small chunks.'** The decomposition is the work. Once chunked, execution is mechanical. The hard part is naming the chunks correctly.

Why it works — the underlying mechanisms

Cognitive load reduction

The brain has limited working memory. Complex tasks that exceed it produce the exact 'overwhelmed' sensation that interferes with starting. Chunking reduces the cognitive load per chunk to a level that fits in working memory. The task does not become easier; the *step in front of you* becomes manageable.

Time as a forcing function

An undefined task can sprawl indefinitely. A time-bounded chunk forces decomposition: you cannot commit to a 60-minute TSSP without first deciding what fits in 60 minutes. The time box itself does the decomposition work.

Output guarantees progress

Without a defined output, a chunk produces nothing durable. With one (a PDF, a draft, a decision log, a captured note), each chunk leaves a permanent artifact in canon. Even on days when little gets done, the artifact is filed and tomorrow's session can build on it.

Starting is the hard part

Most days the difficulty is not the work but the activation energy to begin. A small, well-scoped TSSP lowers the activation energy to near-zero. 'Spend 30 minutes on the engine spec' is starable. 'Build the engine' is not.

Anatomy of a TSSP — the five elements

Every TSSP, regardless of length or type, has five named elements. Naming them at session open is what distinguishes a TSSP from just ‘sitting down to work for a while.’

#	Element	Description	Example
1	Identifier	Timestamp + project + initiator	052026-wed-640pm-UV-CL
2	Type	What kind of work this is	Methodology overview
3	Scope	What will be covered (and what will NOT be)	TSSP concept, leverage refinements
4	Time budget	Planned duration, not a hard ceiling	30-45 minutes
5	Output	The deliverable produced by session close	Reference PDF

Pre-flight check before any substantive TSSP: can I name all five elements in one sentence? If yes, the chunk is ready. If no, the chunking is incomplete and a few minutes of scoping work is required before execution.

TSSP types — the working catalog

Different kinds of work benefit from different chunk structures. Naming the **type** at session open sets expectations for what good looks like at session close. The catalog below reflects the TSSP types UV has been running across the Dr. UVC Market Insights project this week.

TSSP type	Use case	Typical duration	Typical output
Architecture walkthrough	Building shared understanding of model/structure	60-120 min	2 PDFs (transcript + summary)
Live market read	Quick observation + cross-check during market	10-30 min	Captured in rolling session
Spec capture	Documenting model specifications	60-90 min	Canonical spec PDF
Empirical validation	Cross-checking model against historical data	60-90 min	Validation PDF
Strategic decision	Locking decisions across the project portfolio	30-60 min	Decision record
Methodology overview	Meta-method discussion (this document)	30-45 min	Reference PDF
Pink Book capture	Adding new content to journal canon	15-45 min	Atomic capture file
Launch campaign post	Drafting Substack content	60-90 min	Draft document
Cowork directive	Producing build instructions	30-60 min	Directive PDF
Pink/Purple transcription	Moving notebook content to canon	30-60 min	Transcribed pages
Deep work block	Uninterrupted hard thinking on one problem	90-180 min	Breakthrough or honest report on the attempt

The catalog is not closed. Adding a new TSSP type when a recurring kind of work emerges is part of refining the method. Each new type added to the catalog reduces the friction of starting that kind of

work in the future.

The five practical disciplines

Operating TSSP well requires more than naming. The five disciplines below are the ones that turn the concept into reliable practice. Re-read these when sessions start drifting or motivation slips.

Discipline 1 — Name the TSSP explicitly at the start

Every substantive session opens with at least three named elements: type, scope, time budget. Saying these out loud (or typing them at the session open) takes 30 seconds and changes the entire session. Without naming, sessions drift toward whatever is in front of you. With naming, sessions honor their own boundaries.

Compare:

Without naming: 'Let's look at the engine.'

With naming: '052026-wed-640pm-UV-CL · Methodology overview TSSP · scope: TSSP concept and leverage refinements · 30-45 min · output: reference PDF.'

Discipline 2 — Honor the wrap, even if the work is unfinished

Time-boxes only work if you actually stop. The wrap is the most important moment of a TSSP — it is when the deliverable gets produced and the open work gets logged for next time. If you blow past the wrap because 'just a few more minutes,' you erode the discipline that makes future TSSPs trustworthy.

If the work is genuinely incomplete at wrap, the deliverable still gets produced — it just captures 'here is where we are and here is what comes next.' That is itself a valuable deliverable.

Discipline 3 — Produce the output, always

No TSSP closes without an output. The output may be a PDF, a draft, a decision record, an atomic note, a single-page summary — but something durable must exist at close. The output is what makes the chunk count toward cumulative progress. A session that produced great conversation but no artifact is a session that contributed less than it could have.

Discipline 4 — Cap daily TSSP count to protect quality

Guideline: **3-4 substantive TSSPs per day maximum** across all projects. Shorter quick-checks (10-20 minutes) can be unlimited. This is the cognitive-load equivalent of the position-sizing rules in the trading framework: even when individual trades are correctly sized, the portfolio gets overexposed if you take too many.

When tempted to push past the cap, the right question is not 'can I do more?' but 'will my work tomorrow be worse if I push tonight?' Most days the answer is yes. The 4-PDF day is sustainable occasionally; daily would erode the foundation-right pacing.

Discipline 5 — Close with a TSSP closeout checklist

Five items, two minutes. Run these before declaring the TSSP closed:

- Was the time budget honored?
- Is the deliverable produced and filed?
- Are open decisions logged?
- Is the next TSSP scoped (even loosely)?
- Are the wrap PDFs filed in project canon?

When motivation slips — the read-this-first section

This section is why this document exists. Re-read this section first when you feel overwhelmed, when motivation has slipped, or when you find yourself avoiding the work that matters.

The first move is always scope reduction

Overwhelm is a signal that the current scope exceeds working memory. The remedy is not more effort — it is smaller scope. Take whatever you are avoiding and ask: **what is the smallest TSSP I could honestly run on this in the next 30 minutes?** Then commit only to that. Not the whole task. Just the next 30 minutes.

‘Write Post 2 for the launch campaign’ → overwhelming.

‘30-minute TSSP to outline Post 2’ → startable.

‘30-minute TSSP to write three sentences on what Post 2 should accomplish’ → trivially startable.

Trust the protocol when intuition fails

On good days you do not need this document. On hard days you do. The TSSP protocol is what carries you through the hard days — not because the work is easier on hard days, but because the protocol removes decision-making from the moment of low energy. You do not have to figure out what to do; the protocol tells you. **Name the TSSP. Run the TSSP. Wrap the TSSP.** Three steps. The protocol does the thinking for you.

Small TSSPs still count

A 25-minute TSSP that produces one captured page is a real contribution. A 90-minute TSSP that produces nothing because the scope was too ambitious is not. On low-energy days, downsize the TSSP rather than skip it. Showing up for 25 minutes preserves the rhythm; skipping breaks it.

The 50-by-2027 publishing goal needs ~3 TSSPs per week sustained over 19 months. That is 247 sustained weeks of TSSPs — ~750 TSSPs total. Not 750 hero sessions. 750 ordinary chunks. **The goal is sustainability, not intensity.**

Avoid using TSSP to mask procrastination on hard things

Sometimes you chunk something because it is genuinely big. Sometimes you chunk something because the chunked version lets you feel productive while avoiding the part you are not ready to face. Both are valid moves at different times — but worth knowing which one you are doing.

Honest check, every few weeks: **is there a piece of work I keep chunking but never get to the core of?** If yes, that core is the work. Either commit to facing it in a dedicated long block, or honestly retire it from the project list. Both are better than indefinite avoidance dressed as productivity.

How TSSP connects to UV’s larger working method

TSSP is one layer of a larger protocol UV has been operating. Understanding the full stack helps each layer reinforce the others.

Layer	Function	Example
1. Project	The strategic container with an end-state	Dr. UVC Market Insights (July 1 launch)
2. Phase	A multi-week stage within the project	Architecture walkthrough phase (mid-May 2026)
3. TSSP	A single time-bounded chunk of work	Wed afternoon walkthrough of TF-ladder personas
4. Artifact	The durable output of a TSSP	SESSION_SUMMARY + CHAT_TRANSCRIPT PDFs
5. Canon	Cumulative collection of artifacts per project	Project file repository in Claude Project

The five layers reinforce each other. TSSP without artifacts is conversation that evaporates. Artifacts without canon are scattered files. Canon without phases is unstructured accumulation. Phases without projects lose direction. **TSSP is the engine of the system; the other four layers give it durability and meaning.**

Application example — the 50-by-2027 publishing goal

The most overwhelming case in UV’s portfolio. Done in one mental piece, the goal feels impossible. Decomposed via TSSP, it becomes routine arithmetic.

Variable	Value
Target publications	50
Time window	Now (May 2026) through Dec 2027 = ~19 months
Required pace	~1 publication per 12 days
TSSPs per publication (estimate)	5 (outline + 2 drafts + edit + publish)
Total TSSPs over 19 months	250
TSSPs per month	~13
TSSPs per week (sustained)	~3

3 TSSPs per week sustained for 19 months produces 50 publications. That is the entire goal, broken into its smallest practical unit. The number 50 is overwhelming. The number 3-per-week is not. **This is what TSSP gives you — not less work, but a workable framing.**

Honest caveats — what TSSP is not

TSSP is not a productivity hack

Chunking does not increase total work capacity. If 3 TSSPs per week is unsustainable given health, family, market involvement, and the rest of life, the right move is to lower the goal, not to push harder. **Sustainability is the constraint; intensity is the variable.**

Some work needs long blocks, not chunks

Genuine deep work — the kind that requires 90+ minutes of uninterrupted thought — should be protected as a long block. The right pairing: use TSSP for routine and incremental work; protect long blocks for breakthroughs. The week-long architecture walkthrough that produced the eight-persona TF ladder is an example: each session was a TSSP, but each session also operated as a longer block within itself.

Naming overhead is real

If the naming ceremony becomes longer than the work itself, the structure is consuming its own savings. The right level: enough structure to honor chunk boundaries; not so much that the structure becomes work. The five elements (identifier, type, scope, time budget, output) are the minimum useful set.

TSSP does not replace deep thinking about priorities

TSSP is execution discipline. It does not tell you which projects to run, which to retire, which to scale. Those decisions sit above TSSP and need to be revisited periodically. **TSSP makes the right work easier to do; it does not tell you what the right work is.**

Example: this session as a TSSP

This document is itself the output of a TSSP. Filed for posterity as a worked example of the method in action.

Element	This session
1. Identifier	052026-wed-640pm-UV-CL
2. Type	Methodology overview
3. Scope	TSSP concept; leverage refinements; reference manual
4. Time budget	30-45 minutes
5. Output	TSSP_REFERENCE_MANUAL_052026.pdf (this document)

Closing — the protocol in three lines

1. **Name the chunk before starting.** Type, scope, time budget, output.
2. **Run the chunk inside its boundaries.** Honor the time. Produce the output.
3. **Close the chunk cleanly.** File the artifact. Log open items. Scope the next.

When the protocol feels heavy: simplify it. When the protocol feels light: trust it. When motivation is high: do not skip the protocol just because you do not feel you need it — protocol followed on good days is what makes it available on hard days. When motivation is low: do not abandon the protocol. **The TSSP you can barely begin today is the foundation for the work that will feel natural next month.**

Re-read this document whenever overwhelm returns. It will return. That is not failure — it is the nature of running multiple projects in parallel through changing energy and changing life. The protocol exists for those days, not the good ones.

End of TSSP Reference Manual

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Cross-applicable to all Dr. UVC LLC and Dr. UVC AI LLC projects